Swab testing for Flu/COVID-19

1) Wear appropriate PPE

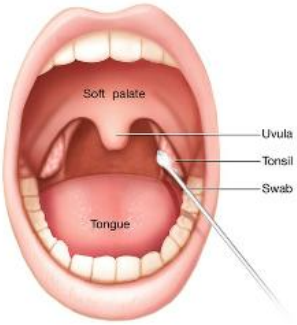
- Wash hands
- Apron, disposable gloves & fluid repellent surgical mask



2) Take 2 x swabs – FLOQ

How to take the throat swab

- Remove swab from the package holding it at end of stick
- Ask patient to tilt head back slightly open mouth wide
- Rub swab at the back of the throat avoiding the tongue or roof of mouth
- Do not lay swab down-keep it in your hand
- Place swab in plastic Tube



3) Packaging

- Put swab in Microbiology Request Form and seal.
- Place Microbiology Request Form in Microbiology Specimens only bag and seal
- Remove PPE and wash hands in soap and water.



4) Transferring the specimen

- 08:00 – 16:00 Contact Microbiology ex 4278 to inform that specimen is on route
- After 16:00 contact Blood Sciences On Call Services (bleep 043)
- Specimen must be transported by member of staff to the Pathology Reception and handed over in person

For next day result swab needs to be in lab by 15:30

URGENT REQUESTS – Any need for 'urgent' swabs to need to be discussed with the on call Microbiologist – **consultant-to-consultant** discussion